**scapegoats, and I am being made the biggest one.**

21

…

**We are well enough looked after here by our friends, at least my medical treatment is looked after. But my wife and I do not understand why a basic constitutional right in the GDR is denied to us – that is, the right to a proper apartment of our own. We do not ask too much, and we want no privileges. All we want is a perfectly normal flat like all other citizens have.**

With the tensions of the past few months having left their mark on Margot Honecker, she suffered a minor heart attack on 19 April 1990. A quick-witted masseuse gave first aid, as Honecker looked on – paralyzed with fright. ‘It was a very terrible situation,’ he recounted. ‘I would not have survived her death.’22

As Margot recovered that summer, the relentless march to reunification continued. The Honeckers met East German Interior Minister, Peter Michael Diestel, during July to discuss the conditions of their accommodation and police measures to ensure their safety. They complained of not being able to exchange old East German currency for Deutsche Marks because their IDs had been confiscated. In September, despite East German doctors deeming Honecker unfit for prison or trial on charges of abuse of power, breach of trust, corruption and treason, GDR authorities handed 500 volumes of files on the former General Secretary and other former leaders to the West German federal prosecutor, who would decide if they should stand trial. On the eve of German reunification, Honecker said he considered all the charges to be untenable and rejected responsibility for the figure, cited by the prosecutor’s office, of 200 killed on the GDR borders. ‘I have no personal guilt for that.’23 Responding to corruption charges, he said: